



VISITOR GUIDE · TRAVELLING RESPONSIBLY

Whitsundays

We can't wait to welcome you to the Whitsundays. A few simple things will help you explore the islands safely, and help protect their reefs and beaches.

FOUR THINGS TO KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

01 Choose Advanced Eco Certified operators

Cruise Whitsundays and others hold Ecotourism Australia Advanced Eco Certification. Reef fees fund Marine Park management, always book certified operators over uncertified ones.

02 Protect Whitehaven Beach — take nothing, leave nothing

The 98% pure silica sand is internationally rare and fragile. No smoking, no glass, and all rubbish must leave with the visitor, there are no bins. The sand must never be removed.

03 Use reef-safe sunscreen and never touch coral

Standard sunscreens damage coral; TGA-approved reef-safe formulas are essential. Clients must float, never stand on or touch the reef.

04 Respect Ngaro sea Country

The Ngaro, Gia and Juru are the Traditional Owners. We'd encourage you to engage respectfully with cultural sites such as Nara Inlet's ancient rock art on Hook Island.

PLEASE TAKE EXTRA CARE

In-water safety. Please wear stinger suits in season (Nov–May), only enter the water with permitted operators, use the buddy system, and attend every crew safety briefing. Marine stingers and currents are genuine risks.

EXPLORING THE WHITSUNDAYS RESPONSIBLY

ENCOURAGE

- + Choose Ecotourism Australia certified operators
- + Use reef-safe, TGA-approved sunscreen
- + Take all rubbish off Whitehaven Beach
- + Keep 100m from whales (300m with calves)
- + Use moorings, never anchor on coral
- + Walk part of the Ngaro Sea Trail
- + Wear a stinger suit in season
- + Join Eye on the Reef citizen science

ADVISE AGAINST

- Remove sand from Whitehaven Beach
- Smoke or bring glass onto Whitehaven
- Touch, stand on or kick coral
- Chase, touch or feed marine wildlife
- Discharge rubbish or fuel overboard
- Disturb nesting turtles or their tracks
- Approach whales within 100m
- Buy souvenirs made from reef species

NGARO SEA COUNTRY

The Ngaro, Gia and Juru people are the Traditional Owners of the Whitsunday lands and seas. The Ngaro, a saltwater people, navigated these islands by canoe for thousands of years. We'd encourage you to visit the Ngaro Sea Trail and Nara Inlet rock art respectfully.